Proposal & working paper · 26 October 2026

Using cloud services through FedRAMP

A signed CSA for the cloud service. A separate ATO for the agency system.

This report reviews a proposed agency workflow and turns it into an eight-step workbook. It is an independent analysis, not official FedRAMP guidance or an authorization.

Agency-use workbook

Use one worksheet per agency use and service; link related records when a system uses several services. Work through the eight records below. Steps 2–5 are iterative: evidence or design changes can send you back. The proposed CSA and the agency system ATO have separate scopes. For a new system, operational use waits for its ATO. Within an existing ATO lifecycle, a new CSA also requires review of whether the system authorization still covers the changed use.

Use references to agency records. This page is a working aid, not the official repository. Answers stay in this browser session unless you choose browser storage or export them. Nothing entered here is sent to a server.

01 RMF · Prepare

Define the work, information, and scope

Responsible participants: Mission owner · information owner · security, privacy, records, and acquisition staff

Record 1 · Define the work, information, and scope

Work and limits

What task, users, and uses are allowed? What is prohibited?

Working example only.
Agency control owner: review team.
<svg onload=alert(1)> must remain text.

Information and flows

Information types, origins, recipients, processing, storage, logs, exports, retention, and disposal. Identify the responsible information owner.

Not recorded.

Scope and applicable obligations

Record the FedRAMP scope provision, offering/version, inclusion or exclusion rationale, other obligations, reviewer, and date.

Not recorded.

02 RMF · Categorize

Categorize information and the agency system

Responsible participants: Information owner · system owner · authorizing official or delegate

Record 2 · Categorize information and the agency system

Information-type ratings

For each type: confidentiality / integrity / availability impact; concrete harm; rationale; approving official.

Not recorded.

System category and approval

System name, impact by objective, overall impact, aggregation considerations, approval/date, and separate privacy risks.

Not recorded.

03 RMF · Prepare + Select

Set the boundary and allocate controls

Responsible participants: System owner · security/privacy architects · common control providers

Record 3 · Set the boundary and allocate controls

Boundary and dependencies

Describe or link the diagram: agency resources, provider offering, interfaces, inherited services, and exclusions with reasons.

Not recorded.

Control allocation and tailoring

For each requirement/control: rationale, parameter, agency/provider/shared owner, implementation, evidence needed, and monitoring owner. Record SA-9 oversight and monitoring assignments.

Not recorded.

04 RMF · Select + risk assessment

Reuse FedRAMP evidence and decide whether the service fits

Responsible participants: System owner · assessors · security/privacy staff · acquisition team

Record 4 · Reuse FedRAMP evidence and decide whether the service fits

Selected offering and evidence

Provider/service/version/deployment, package identifier and date, status/class or impact basis as applicable, features and inherited services covered, reviewers, and evidence links.

Not recorded.

Fit, gaps, and reuse

Required capability → provider evidence → agency configuration/work → residual gap/risk. Identify stale or missing evidence.

Not recorded.

Additional provider requirements, if any

Distinguish clarification from added requirements. State demonstrable need, determining official, notification/reference, package conflicts, and resolution. Enter “none” when appropriate.

Not recorded.

05 RMF · Proposed FedRAMP CSA process · supports Select and Implement

Perform and sign a Cloud Service Authorization

Responsible participants: Agency CSA signing official · system owner · acquisition, security, and privacy staff

Record 5 · Perform and sign a Cloud Service Authorization

Agreements and control references

Contract/agreement reference → requirement → responsible party → evidence/remedy. Map the CSA identifier and version to SA-9, SA-4, CA-3, and other applicable agency-system control entries.

Not recorded.

CSA decision and signed record

Status (draft, approved, denied, or deferred); CSA ID/version; FedRAMP CSA procedure/version; agency system ID; service and approved information/use; requirements, responsibilities, evidence, residual risk, conditions and monitoring; signing official/authority, signature/date and signed-record location; linked system ATO. This worksheet does not sign the CSA.

Not recorded.

06 RMF · Implement + Assess

Configure, integrate, and assess the agency's implementation

Responsible participants: System owner · implementers · control assessors

Record 6 · Configure, integrate, and assess the agency's implementation

Agency implementation and assessment

Implemented settings/procedures, evidence links, assessor/date, provider evidence reused, inherited capabilities checked, and integration tests/results.

Not recorded.

Findings and risk response

Finding → affected mission/information → owner → mitigation or acceptance → due date. Link provider remediation and record any agency compensating actions.

Not recorded.

07 RMF · Authorize

Authorize the agency information system under FISMA

Responsible participants: Agency authorizing official

Record 7 · Authorize the agency information system under FISMA

Agency system ATO and CSA references

System/package ID; ATO official, decision/date and signed-record location; approved scope, information, configuration, residual risk and conditions; linked CSA IDs/versions and SA-9/SA-4/other control references; review triggers. Record denial, deferral, or the treatment of a change to an existing ATO.

Not recorded.

ATO submission and proposed CSA reporting

Date/reference and agency ATO letter/supplementary information supplied to FedRAMP, or why not applicable. Separately identify any CSA reporting that the new procedure would require; do not assume it replaces the ATO submission.

Not recorded.

08 RMF · Monitor + disposal

Monitor both, respond to change, and plan exit

Responsible participants: System owner · monitoring staff · authorizing official · service contacts

Record 8 · Monitor both, respond to change, and plan exit

Monitoring plan

Evidence/report → review frequency → reviewer → trigger/threshold → action/official.
Include provider and agency sources, inherited services, and continuity of contacts.

Long-answer print check. Long-answer print check. Long-answer print check.

Change, incident, and exit plan

Triggers for re-review, restrictions or suspension; incident coordination/notification; export/retention/deletion; account/key closure; transition owner; completion evidence.

Not recorded.

What the completed record should show

The authorizing official should be able to trace the decision from the agency's information and mission to the selected service, evidence, customer responsibilities, assessment results, conditions, and ongoing monitoring. The completed package should identify two separate signed decisions: the service CSA under the proposed FedRAMP procedure and the agency system ATO. This worksheet helps assemble and cross-reference them; exporting it does not sign either decision.

- **Scope:** the actual agency use, information, system boundary, and provider offering.
- **Protection:** categorization, selected controls, allocation, agreements, and verified implementation.
- **Evidence:** FedRAMP material reused, agency assessment, unresolved issues, and justified additions.
- **Decisions:** the CSA signing official, authority, signature/date and record; the separate system ATO and its official; CSA references in SA-9, SA-4, and other controls; and the applicable submission requirements.
- **Continued use:** monitoring owners, evidence cadence, escalation, change triggers, and exit arrangements.

Return to workbook controls